

Game Design Document: Fear of Unknown

Title: Fear of Unknown

Team name: Fear of Unknown Design Group

Team member:

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1 Slogan

All fear comes from the unknown and the lack of firepower.

2 Top-level summary of your game idea

Fear of Unknown is a horror-themed first-person shooter game. Players will be attacked by unknown creatures during a space station rescue mission. Players need to explore, shoot, and hide to find themselves a chance of survival. The key to the game is to find useful information, enough energy, and powerful weapons under stress and panic.

3 Player experience goal(s) + atmosphere users should experience

We aim to attract players who like to play horror games and FPS games. The goal of our game is that the player will be immersed in a terrifying environment, stimulated by both visual and auditory stimuli while exploring and fighting. Players are constantly stimulated in the process of playing, feeling a sense of crisis when hiding and feeling weak when fighting. As a horror game, it will make the player breathe fast, the heart rate will increase, and the adrenaline will be pumped.

For the items below, X represents what we want this game to be in scale.

Items from Lazzaro's 4 Keys 2 Fun (2014):

Hard Fun: mastery, achievement, "fiero"): not at all
|-----X-----| highly
so

Easy Fun: Exploring, Imagination, Curiosity, Absorption	not at all -----X----- highly so
Altered States (Serious Fun): Values & Meaning	not at all -----X----- highly so
People Fun: Relationships, social bonding etc.	not at all -----X----- highly so

Items from Yee's Player Motivation Taxonomy (2006):

Achievement component

Advancement — The desire to gain power, progress rapidly, accumulate in-game symbols of wealth or status	not at all -----X---- highly so
Mechanics —analyzing the underlying rules and system in order to optimize character performance	not at all -----X----- highly so
Competition — The desire to challenge and compete with others	not at all ---X----- highly so

Social component

Socializing — Having an interest in helping and chatting with other players	not at all ---X----- highly so
Relationship — The desire to form long-term, meaningful relationships with others	not at all ---X----- highly so
Teamwork — Deriving satisfaction from being part of a group effort.	not at all -X----- highly so

Immersion component

Discovery — Finding and knowing things that most other players don't know about	not at all -----X----- highly so
Role-Playing — Creating a persona with a background story and interacting with other players to create an improvised story	not at all ---X----- highly so
Customization — Having an interest in customizing the appearance of their character	not at all --X----- highly so
Escapism — Using the online environment to avoid thinking about real-life problems	not at all -----X----- highly so

Summary

According to Lazarro's 4 Keys to Fun, we aim for players to experience both "Hard Fun" and "Easy Fun" through the challenges of aiming, resource management, exploration, and imagination. "People Fun" is less focused as this is a single-player experience. "Serious Fun" is also not our primary goal since we hope players enjoy the game without spending too much time on the "big idea" of the game.

In Yee's Player Motivation taxonomy, we target the "Achievement" and "Immersion" components. Players will have the satisfaction of becoming stronger and mastering mechanics. What's more, we want the player to try their best to find all the hidden clues to progress the game. Social components are less relevant, but it would be better if the players formed a community to discuss our game.

4 Introduction

The premise of the game is that the protagonist must explore the research space station alone, uncovering the truth about the unknown alien creatures and trying to survive their attacks.

The primary goal for players is to survive in the space station, investigate information about the creatures, use weapons for self-defence, and collect enough energy to escape safely with backup spacecraft.

5 Narrative/Story

The story is that the protagonist received a distress signal, and the mission was to rescue researchers who were doing research on alien life on another space station. The protagonist connected two space stations, and after entering, he found that almost everyone had died. The only survivor is the person who sent the distress signal, who is hiding in an isolation cabin, waiting for the protagonist's rescue. Unfortunately, however, when the scientist was explaining what happened to the protagonist, he was suddenly killed. The protagonist was left alone to explore the entire scientific research space station, collect information about alien life, and look for weapons for self-defence. When the protagonist tries to escape, he finds that these unknown creatures have invaded his space station, so he has to collect enough energy and start the backup spacecraft to return to Earth.

6 Game mechanics

Exploration Mechanics

The player will explore multiple rooms of the research space station, searching for clues and resources. This mechanic encourages investigation, allowing players to unlock areas and collect information that piece together the whole story.

Resource Management Mechanics

Players must manage limited resources like ammo and medical supplies. This mechanic creates challenges that require the player to make decisions on when and how to use these resources in a stressful and scary environment.

Combat Mechanics

As players encounter threats, they need to find and use weapons for self-defence. Combat mechanics test the player's aiming skills.

Information Gathering Mechanics

Players need to find clues about the alien creatures, such as their vulnerability. This challenge requires players to summarize the useful information for progressing the game and achieving the goal.

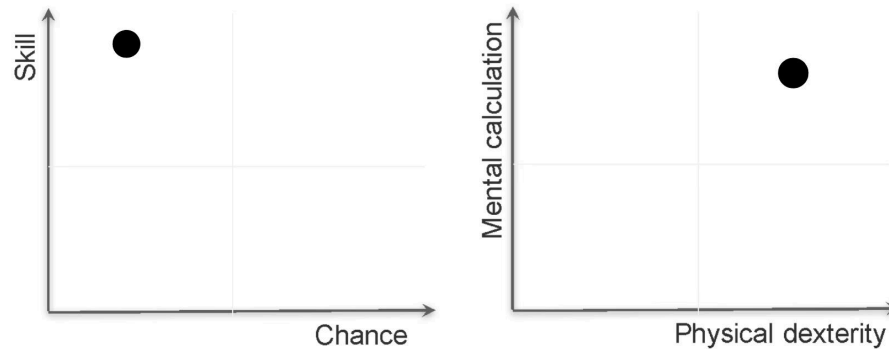
Escape Mechanics

The player must complete tasks, such as collecting enough energy or repairing systems to power the backup spacecraft.

Hiding Mechanics

The game creates an atmosphere of fear. The players can choose to hide from enemies instead of fighting with them directly. Hiding spots, like lockers, allow players to avoid combat. This mechanic enhances the psychological tension, which requires the player to remain alert and reinforces the horror atmosphere, as the players must decide when to fight and when to hide. Some seemingly safe hiding spots will not allow you to escape danger and will be detected by some powerful enemies.

7 Play matrix



Since it's a horror-themed FPS game, it requires more skills than luck. The player must use their aiming skill to kill the enemies. There are still some elements that may require luck, such as finding a powerful weapon or guessing a password without a clue. Our game will have a great balance between mental calculation and physical dexterity. The player not only needs steady and accurate shooting skills but also needs to think correctly through the summary of useful information to help achieve the goal.

8 Playtesting script, including testing goals, questions, and assumptions/hypotheses

Test 1: Test the atmosphere

- **Hypothesis:**
 - Players should feel that the game creates a scary atmosphere and feel thrilled while playing.
- **Questions:**
 - Do you feel scared while playing? Do the enemies and the environment give you pressure?
- **Observation:**
 - Whether the player will be scared when playing or nervous when exploring unknown territory.
- **Revision:**
 - Add or change the game's layout, picture, or sound effects. Adjust the difficulty.

Test 2: Test the resource management mechanics

- **Hypothesis:**
 - Players should feel pressure to manage resources carefully.
- **Question:**

- Did you feel like you had enough resources (ammo, energy, health) to survive, or were you often in need?
- **Observations:**
 - Observe how frequently players run low on resources and if they seem stressed or frustrated by it.
- **Revision:**
 - Adjust the amount and location of resources based on whether players feel the scarcity is too challenging or too easy.

Test 3: Test Combat and Hiding Mechanics

- **Hypothesis:**
 - The player should strike a balance between choosing to fight and hiding.
- **Questions:**
 - Were any enemies too challenging or too easy? How did you feel about the hiding mechanic? Did it feel useful, and did you know when to use it?
- **Observations:**
 - Observe if players choose to hide versus engage in combat and if they seem comfortable using the hiding spots.
- **Revision:**
 - Consider balancing enemy difficulty or providing additional guidance if players struggle with either combat or hiding.

9 Analyze your game in terms of decision types, dilemmas, rewards, surprises, and endings.

9.1 Decision Types

- The player has to decide which area to explore.
- The player has to choose whether to hide or fight.

9.2 Dilemmas

- If the player does not explore the environment to collect useful information and resources, the battle becomes extremely difficult, but the process of exploration also requires fighting.
- If the player keeps hiding, the progress of the game will become very slow, and some areas will not be able to be passed. If the player keeps fighting, they may die many times.

9.3 Rewards

- As the player progresses the game to the next stage, the player's abilities and equipment improve.

9.4 Surprise

- The player may be surprised by the sudden appearance of enemies (jump scare).
- The player will discover useful information during exploration that will greatly reduce the difficulty (enemy weaknesses).

9.5 Endings

- The player needs to escape to reach the end of the game successfully, but there are easter eggs at the end to introduce the game's next chapter.
- The end of the game will be satisfying, and the player will have a sense of accomplishment of escaping and a sense of relief from the stress.

The text we want to include in the game to introduce the enemies

Daily Report of New Discovered Alien Species

Intro:

The following report details a study of a newly discovered alien species observed under controlled experimental conditions. The study will document behavioural and physiological changes in the species over several days.

Stage 1: Days 1-3

Characteristics Observed: In the first phase of observation, the creatures exhibited general aggression, only making typical defensive responses when provoked. Their size is relatively small, and their mobility, while striking, does not pose a great threat. The main forms of engagement consist of simple lunges and bites.

Vulnerability: At this stage, these creatures are relatively easy to kill. Containment pods and sedatives are enough. Ordinary weapons can easily kill them.

Behavioural Patterns: They're more like social animals. They don't hurt their own kind.

Note: They seem to be evolving, and the researchers are going to select some biological samples to experiment with.

Stage 2: Days 4-7

Characteristics Observed: By the second stage, some of the subjects became more difficult to kill and were able to heal themselves in the event of non-fatal injuries. They increased in size by about 30 percent while also evolving an explosive shell.

Explosive Defense Mechanism: A particularly alarming feature observed during this phase is that these creatures self-explode when they sense danger. Can cause serious damage to living organisms. The research team should strengthen the control of the experimental subjects. A new security conference will be convened.

Notes: They're evolving rapidly!!!

Stage 3: Days 8-12

Characteristics Observed: One of the creatures appears to have evolved into a third stage. It becomes very aggressive, attacks frequently, and seems to want to break free. It tries to kill anything that comes near, including its own kind.

Keen Senses: The creatures' vision, smell, and hearing evolved to be exceptionally sharp. They can pinpoint the location of their prey and hunt it very quickly.

Physiological Changes: Its exoskeleton became nearly indestructible. The high-calibre projectiles and energy-based weapons can barely hurt it. Currently, there's no way to kill it, so we locked it in a room and tried to figure out the solution.

Notes: We must terminate the project now. The research seems to be out of our control!!!!

Game Rules

Game controls

W is for moving forward

A is for moving left

D is for moving right

S is for moving backward

The shift is to accelerate

C is for crouch

Space for jump

Ctrl is for getting down on the ground

The left mouse button is for fire

The right mouse button is for aim (if possible)

R is for reloading

The mouse wheel is for changing items and weapon

F is for collection, gathering items, and Interacting with the scene

The tab is for backpacks, where players can see what they have collected

Esc is going to the Setting interface, where players can go to change their settings, save, and go back to the home page

The basic operation of the game

In this game, the players can control their players with a keyboard and mouse. In this game, the main target for the players is to escape from a monster-infested environment. They can use W, S, A, D, Jump, Crouch, Shift, lying down to run, and hide to dodge the attack from the monsters.

- WASD keys: for basic movement (W forward, A left, S back, D right).
- Jump (spacebar): allows the player to jump over or leap onto platforms
- Crouch (C): causes the player to crouch down, reducing the chance of being spotted by monsters and being able to enter narrow spaces.
- Run (Shift key): provides a short acceleration but consumes stamina, which needs to be managed wisely by the player.
- Get down on the ground (Ctrl Key): the player can lie flat on the ground in order to hide under objects or in tight spaces to avoid being spotted by monsters.

Players can use a mouse to control the weapon they get on the map to defend themselves and gain more time to run away. They can also find clues on the map to gain special items or escape the room and run away from the monster. The players can open their bags to use items they collect to progress the game.

- Mouse Controls: The player can use the mouse to aim and use weapons found on the map to attack/kill enemies. This requires precise aiming and timing.
- R key: to reload the weapon so that the player can get enough ammo to fire.
- Mouse wheel: use the mouse wheel to change weapons against different kinds of enemies or switch to items to use.
- Backpack and Item Bar: Press the Tab to access the backpack. Here, the player can view and use special items collected, such as healing potions, temporary shields, or keys, to help explore new areas.

Special control instructions

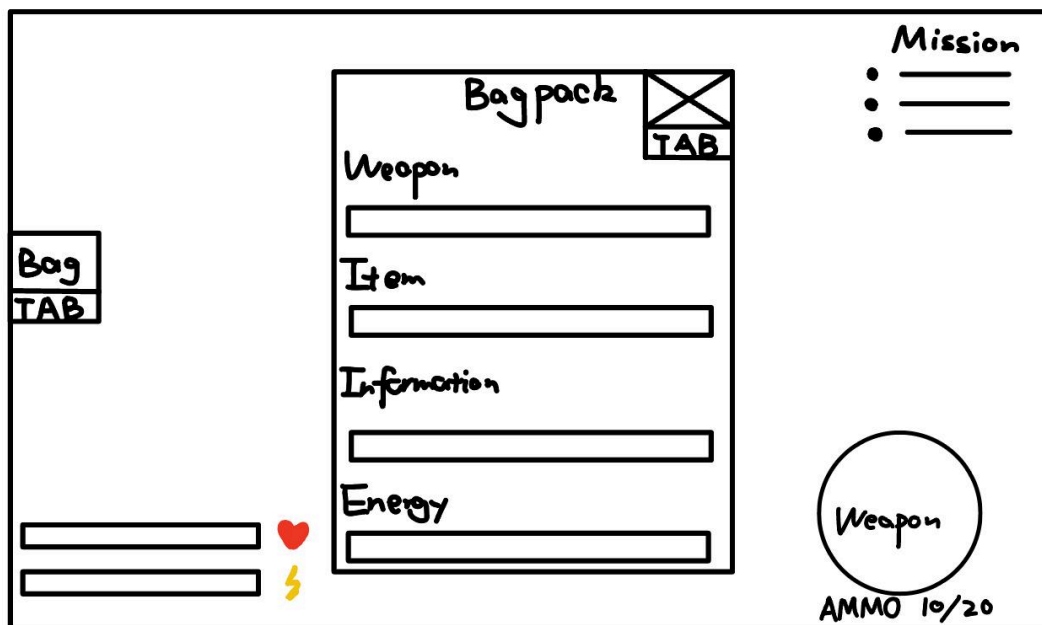
The players can interact with the special area on the map to hide or interact by pressing the F key.

User Interface Explained

The health bar and stamina bar will show on the left-down corner. The picture of the weapon will show in the right-down corner, and they will use a mouse wheel to change their weapon.

When players press the TAB key, the backpack interface will show up and show the players what they have in their bag: Weapons, information, items and energy.

The primary mission players need to do will show in the top right corner.



Little Hint

There will be a hint for the main missions players need to do with a little exclamation mark! It is to give players hints about what they can or should do now so that they can learn how to play.

Also, the items that can be interacted with or picked up on the map will have the text (highlight)
“Press xxx to interact, pick up.”